wanted incomes to be capped to ‘a maximum of Rs 2000 p.m. and a minimum of Rs 100 p.m. with efforts to raise the minimum so that in the foreseeable future the highest and the lowest incomes may bear a ratio of 10:1’.

8 February 1957: Jan Sangh manifesto demands nationalisation of basic and defence industries, says private sector’s role is to aid the development of India.

1962: Jan Sangh crosses double figures in Parliament for the first time, winning fourteen Lok Sabha seats.

- The cow first appears on the Jan Sangh’s manifesto in 1962 when it declared that it would ‘amend the Constitution to prohibit the slaughter of the bovine species and enact necessary legislation’. The party also promised to establish dairies, goshalas and gosadans.

3 November 1966: Jan Sangh adopts a resolution extending all-out support to the all-party Cow Protection Movement for a total ban on cow slaughter. The resolution said the Constitution must be amended to enact a law to ban cow slaughter and said the blame should not be shifted to state governments.

1967: Deen Dayal Upadhyaya becomes Jan Sangh president, reorganises party into regional zones, each headed by a former pracharak.

1967: Jan Sangh enters into alliances with ideologically different parties for the first time, under a policy spearheaded by Nanaji Deshmukh and Atal Bihari Vajpayee, with Deen Dayal Upadhyaya’s approval.

- Jan Sangh joins Samyukta Vidhayak Dal (SVD), a grand alliance of Opposition parties, against the Congress in national and state elections in 1967.
- New SVD government comes to power in several states with Jan Sangh as a key partner. In UP, Jan Sangh wins ninety-eight (the highest after Congress’s 199) of 425 assembly seats as part of the alliance. Jan Sangh leaders join the new UP